Minjoon Choi

Seoul, South Korea minjchoi@umd.edu m-joon-ixix.github.io

Research Interests

Reliable & Trustworthy NLP, Knowledge-Aware LLMs, Factuality & Coherence, Vision-Language Models (VLMs)

Education

University of Maryland, College Park *Starting Aug 2026*
Ph.D. Student in Computer Science
Advisor: Prof. Mohit Iyyer

Seoul National University *Mar 2019 – Feb 2026*
B.S. in Computer Science GPA: 4.05/4.3
Summa Cum Laude, Leave of absence for mandatory military service (May 2021 - Apr 2023)

University of Washington *Mar 2025 – Jun 2025*
University-Wide Exchange Student GPA: 4.0/4.0

Hana Academy Seoul *Mar 2015 – Feb 2018*
High School Diploma

Professional Experience

Software Engineer *Mar 2021 – Feb 2024*
Dunamu Inc. — Stockplus Backend-Team *Seoul, South Korea*
Selected as Industrial Technical Personnel (Alternative Military Service)

- Engineered high-scale backend systems serving 600K MAU using Ruby on Rails & Kotlin Spring
- Led the development of systems for user assets and financial news content
- Architected and deployed microservices, transitioning from legacy infrastructure to improve scalability
- Optimized MySQL databases reducing query latency & Maintained production infrastructure on Kubernetes

Research Experience

Undergraduate Research Intern *Jun 2025 – Nov 2025*
University of Washington, Information School *Seattle, WA / Remote*

- Advisor: Prof. Lucy Lu Wang
- Developed an abstention mechanism for VLMs to enhance model reliability by calibrating verbal confidence with its visual perception and reasoning processes
- Contributed to research on the current practices and challenges of human evaluation in NLP studies

Undergraduate Researcher *Apr 2025 – Jun 2025*
University of Washington — CSE 499 *Seattle, WA*

- Probed LLM hidden layer representations to investigate the internal knowledge consolidation process

Undergraduate Research Intern *Jun 2024 – Feb 2025*
Seoul National University, Department of Computer Science & Engineering *Seoul, South Korea*

- Advisor: Prof. Sang-goo Lee
- Developed a unified framework for the alignment of language models towards reliable behaviors when facing knowledge conflicts or uninformative external documents

Teaching Experience

Computer Programing (M1522.000600) *Fall 2025*
Head Teaching Assistant
Seoul National University, Department of Computer Science & Engineering

- Instructor: Prof. Ohchul Kwon
- Developed programming questions for mandatory lab sessions, Coordinated weekly lab sessions, Graded assignments, Overall course management

Database Systems (M1522.001800) *Fall 2024*
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
Seoul National University, Department of Computer Science & Engineering

- Instructor: Prof. Sang-goo Lee
- Arranged in-class quiz sessions, Q&A on project assignments, Graded exams and assignments

Publications

Illusions of the Gold Standard: A Large-scale Analysis of Human Evaluation Protocols for Long-form Text Generation *ACL 2026*
Katelyn X. Mei, Yi-Li Hsu, Minjoon Choi, Zongwan Cao, Chenjun Xu, Bingbing Wen, Su Lin Blodgett, Lucy Lu Wang

RoParQ: Paraphrase-Aware Alignment of Large Language Models Towards Robustness to Paraphrased Questions *2025 arXiv Preprint*
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Reliability Across Parametric and External Knowledge: Understanding Knowledge Handling in LLMs *2025 arXiv Preprint*
Youna Kim, Minjoon Choi, Sungmin Cho, Hyuhng Joon Kim, Sang-goo Lee, Taeuk Kim

Poster Presentations

Towards the Use of Layer-to-Layer Stability Patterns for Early Accuracy Estimation in Question Answering *ICCE-Asia 2025*
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Honors & Awards

Dean's Fellowship *Fall 2026 - Spring 2028*
Presented by University of Maryland, Department of Computer Science

Honor of Summa Cum Laude *Feb 2026*
Presented by Seoul National University

Korea & USA Advanced Field Student Exchange Funding Scholarship *Spring 2025*
Presented by Korea Institute for Advancement of Technology

Semiconductor Specialized University Scholarship *Fall 2023 - Fall 2025*
Presented by Korea Institute for Advancement of Technology & Ministry of Education

Merit Based Academic Scholarship *Fall 2020 - Fall 2025*
Presented by Seoul National University

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, Ruby, Java, Kotlin, C, C#, C++, MySQL, R, OCaml, LaTeX

Frameworks: Spring, Ruby on Rails, Pytorch, Pandas, Numpy

Tools: Git, Notion, Unity, Blender

Languages

Korean: Native

English: Full Professional Proficiency — IELTS: 8.0